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Mike Rowe

TRIUMF
4004 Wesbrook Mall
Vancouver, BC

Re: Application for Control System Engineer Role

Dear Mike Rowe,

For just over a year, I have been volunteering under Dr. Chris Charles' supervision. Through my first project of developing driver for a discontinued and undocumented stepper motor, I was introduced to the EPICS control system. Recognizing the scope of EPICS in academic and industrial environments as well as the growing momentum in industrial automation, I saw potential for a career that is both stable and exciting. My next project was chosen for scale: as an academic institution, TRIUMF has high churn as students, work placements, and post-doctorate researchers begin and complete their curated projects. EPICS being the irreplaceable bridge between research and engineering, I recognized the labour cost of repeated software onboarding. I thus set to, and succeeded in developing a fully automated and air-gapped EPICS server installation script.

As students are increasingly trained in software development¹, we are poised to see an increased pressure towards experimental automation. By building out digital infrastructure in my current role, I have gained invaluable experience in connecting end users to isolated facets of complex software. Moreover, my experience at the intersection of regulatory approval and automation processes at IBC Technologies has familiarized me with the stringent demands on safety, auditability, and precision that are required in industrial environments.

I acknowledge that the posted role requires qualification for P.Eng. status, which I do not have. If there is flexibility in this requirement, I am eager to continue my academic journey. It is fitting within my career trajectory to either pursue enrolment in an appropriate graduate program or challenge the EGBC test roster to facilitate my Professional Engineer registration path.

Over the time I have spent at TRIUMF, I have come to appreciate the culture around how people engage with their work. The pride, humility, and good humour that exists within TRIUMF as a workplace is something that I deeply admire, and it has motivated my continued involvement with the ASPIRE lab in addition to the workload imposed by my current vocation. My peers will attest to the enthusiasm with which I talk of the research taking place at TRIUMF, and I would consider it a privilege to make it into my career.

I recognize that there is likely much competition for this role, but I am confident in my ability to deliver outstanding work in a way that benefits not only the project at hand, but the organization of TRIUMF in its posterity. I would be terrifically excited to be considered for the open role of Control System Engineer, and am available at your (earliest) convenience if you would like to discuss the intersection between my skills and your requirements in greater detail.

Cordially,

Jacob Mattie

¹<https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s11528-019-00384-4>